

Adding a video to a Highlight

Videos go into a Highlight's **Description** as a fenced `embed` block. It is the only syntax that renders — a video link pasted on its own stays a plain link.

The block

Paste this into the Description field and swap the URL. One block is one video; for several videos, add several blocks anywhere in the text.

TEMPLATE

```
```embed
url: https://www.facebook.com/reel/1527219472411989
orientation: vertical
caption: An optional caption
```
```

Fields

| FIELD | | WHAT TO WRITE |
|-------------|-----------------|---|
| url | REQUIRED | Exactly one YouTube or Facebook video link, starting with <code>https://</code> . Two <code>url:</code> lines in one block is an error. |
| orientation | OPTIONAL | <code>horizontal</code> for normal 16:9 video, <code>vertical</code> for reels and shorts. Always write it — see below. |
| caption | OPTIONAL | Free text, shown under the video. Leave the line out if you don't want one. |

ALWAYS WRITE THE ORIENTATION LINE

If you leave `orientation:` out, a reel or short renders in a wide 16:9 frame with black bars down both sides. The admin and the website currently disagree about what a missing orientation means, so make it explicit every time and the question never comes up.

Putting one on a Highlight

1

Open the Highlight in the admin

Go to `/admin/`, sign in, then **Home** → **Highlights**. Click the highlight you want, or **Add Highlight** for a new one.

2

Write the description text first

The homepage carousel shows the first 200 characters of the Description as plain text. Start with a sentence or two of real prose so the carousel has something to show, then put the video block after it.

3

Add the embed block

Leave a blank line, then paste the block. Type the field lines exactly — no space before the colon, and everything on its own line.

DESCRIPTION FIELD

The Ad hoc Committee took office at NRCS National Headquarters on 3 Ashar 2083.

```
```embed
url: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=950IpNwmPaY
orientation: horizontal
caption: Chairman's address to the Society
```
```

4

Save

The admin checks every block when you save. A bad URL or a malformed field is rejected with a message at the top of the form and nothing is stored — fix it and save again. The editor's own preview pane shows the block as grey code, which is normal; it does not preview video.

5

Rebuild the site

The public site is a static export built from a snapshot of the admin data, so saving alone does not change the live page. The video appears after the next site build and deploy, which refetches content from the admin.

Links that work

Copy the link straight from the browser address bar or the platform's Share menu.

YouTube

`https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VIDEOID`

`https://youtu.be/VIDEOID`

`https://www.youtube.com/shorts/VIDEOID`

`https://www.youtube.com/live/VIDEOID`

`https://www.youtube.com/embed/VIDEOID`

Extra bits after the link like `&list=` or `&t=` are fine — they're ignored. **Not accepted:** `music.youtube.com`, `youtube-nocookie.com`.

Facebook

`https://www.facebook.com/reel/NUMBER`

`https://www.facebook.com/watch/?v=NUMBER`

`https://www.facebook.com/PAGE/videos/NUMBER`

`https://www.facebook.com/video.php?v=NUMBER`

`https://fb.watch/CODE`

The video must be public. **Not accepted:** links to a post that merely contains a video, profile or page links, private videos.

EVERYTHING ELSE

Instagram, TikTok, Vimeo and direct `.mp4` links are not supported and will be refused on save.

When the admin refuses to save

The message appears in red at the top of the form. Each one has a single cause.

| MESSAGE | FIX |
|--|---|
| An embed block must contain a 'url:' line. | The <code>url:</code> line is missing, or it's written <code>url :</code> with a space before the colon. The colon must come straight after the word. |
| An embed 'url:' line must contain a URL. | The <code>url:</code> line is there but empty. Paste the link after it. |

| MESSAGE | FIX |
|---|---|
| An embed block must contain a single video. | Two <code>url:</code> lines in one block. Split them into two blocks. |
| Unsupported embed URL: '...' | Not a YouTube or Facebook video link, or the <code>https://</code> is missing from the front. |
| Invalid embed orientation: '...' | Only <code>horizontal</code> and <code>vertical</code> are accepted — not <code>portrait</code> , <code>landscape</code> , or <code>9:16</code> . |

It saved, but the video isn't there

| WHAT YOU SEE | WHY |
|---|--|
| The old page, no video | The site hasn't been rebuilt since you saved. Admin edits reach the public site only through a build and deploy. |
| The block showing as literal text on the homepage | The carousel prints the first 200 characters of the Description as plain text. Move the block further down, behind some prose. |
| A grey code box on the highlight's page | The opening fence isn't exactly <code>```embed</code> , or the closing <code>```</code> is missing. |
| Nothing at all where the video should be | The block has no usable <code>url:</code> line, so it was skipped rather than printed as code. |
| A tall video squeezed into a wide black frame | <code>orientation: vertical</code> is missing on a reel or short. |
| The player itself says the video is unavailable | The block is fine — the video is private, restricted, or deleted on YouTube or Facebook. Check it plays in a logged-out browser. |

The same `embed` block works in any markdown content field in the admin — News, Blogs and Resources all accept it and validate it the same way.